

Body hair choices

Some people prefer to remove their body hair, while others decide to keep it or trim it. There are no rules about what to do with body hair, nor is there any medical reason to remove it.

▽ Personal preference

Deciding what to do with body hair is all about personal preference. There are advantages and disadvantages to each option.

MYTH BUSTER

The truth about hair removal

Shaving doesn't cause hair to grow back darker and thicker. Shaving the hair doesn't alter how it regrows.

You shouldn't squeeze or tweeze an ingrown hair. To avoid breaking the skin, which can cause infection, gently exfoliate the skin to release the ingrown hair from underneath.

	How it works	Advantages	Disadvantages
Hair removal creams	Chemicals dissolve hair at or slightly below the skin surface	- Effective over large areas - No stubble	Can irritate the skin
Keeping	Leaves the hair natural	No cost, fuss, or effort	Armpit hair can trap bacteria and encourage body odor
Plucking	Removes hair at the root, using tweezers	- Can reduce regrowth - Lasts about a week	Can be painful, or cause irritation of hair roots and scarring
Shaving	Cuts off hair at the skin surface	- Painless - Cheap, easy, and quick	Can result in skin irritation or cuts
Waxing	Removes hair at the root, using wax strips	- Lasts three to six weeks - Can reduce regrowth	- Can irritate the skin - Can be painful - Can be expensive

Shaving facial hair

When thicker hairs begin to appear on a boy's chin and upper lip, he might start thinking about shaving. Whether or not a boy shaves is down to personal preference, but a trusted adult can help with the decision.



△ 1. Choose a razor or electric shaver. Shaving after a bath or shower is best, as the skin is soft and hydrated.



△ 2. If using a razor, apply a shaving cream or gel first—this reduces the risk of cuts.



△ 3. Shave in the same direction as hair growth. Going the opposite way can irritate the skin.



△ 4. Wash with soap and water, then apply moisturizing lotion to avoid skin dryness.



△ 5. If using a razor, change the blades regularly so they stay sharp.